Class 41 Reading Homework

Era 15: World War I (1914–1919) · Focus: Neutrality · entry · mobilization

Reading due today: AMSCO 7.5*

Connect: Wilson entered WWI to 'make the world safe for democracy.' Compare his framing to McKinley's justification for the Spanish-American War (Class 36). What's the same tactic?

Learning Objective(s) for today

– **7.5 (LO F):** Explain the causes and consequences of U.S. involvement in World War I.

As you read, identify each of the following:

Terms (define in 1–2 sentences)

[ ] M.A.I.N. causes
[ ] neutrality
[ ] Selective Service
[ ] War Industries Board
[ ] CPI
[ ] Espionage & Sedition Acts

People (name + role/significance in 1 sentence)

[ ] W. Wilson
[ ] J. Pershing

Events (year + one-sentence significance)

[ ] Lusitania sunk (1915)
[ ] Zimmermann Telegram (1917)
[ ] US declares war (Apr 1917)

Reading Focus Questions

Answer in 2–4 complete sentences each. Use specific evidence from the reading.

1. Why did the U.S. try to stay neutral in WWI (1914-1917), and what specific events broke that neutrality?

2. Explain the Zimmermann Telegram: what did Germany propose to Mexico, and how did it affect U.S. public opinion?

3. Once the U.S. entered the war, how did American forces affect the fighting? Cover: the American Expeditionary Force, the Western Front, and the armistice.